

addresses in the same application. Empathy comes with the perks of seamless audio and video chat over the XMPP and Jabber network.

While playing around, I found the touch-pad would not allow me to tap to click. I fixed this with a small tweak in mouse settings (*System -> Preferences -> Mouse*), where I selected the option *Enable mouse clicks with touchpad*.

Table 1 shows the applications installed by default in Fedora 13.

Multimedia

Though Fedora 13 includes the Totem and Rhythmbox media players, they lack codec support for MP3 and other proprietary file formats. You need to install a few plug-ins to fix this. Since I prefer VLC as my media player, I went ahead and installed VLC player with these three commands:

```
$ su -
# rpm -ivh http://download1.rpmfusion.org/free/
# fedora/rpmfusion-free-release-stable.noarch.rpm
# yum install vlc
```

Figure 2 shows VLC being installed, while Figure 3 shows it in action.

Other applications I use in my day-to-day activity are K3B, an optical disk writing program, and Wine, an emulation layer for running Windows programs; so I installed these applications. One impressive thing about Fedora 13, in contrast to my past experience with Fedora Core 2, is automatic resolution of package dependencies. In FC2, dependencies were a pain, since one had to manually download and install dependency packages before finally installing the desired package. But now in Fedora 13, dependencies are resolved automatically, and installation and upgrades happen very

smoothly. Once the installation is over, the terminal shows the various dependencies which were resolved. This is quite impressive!

```
$ su -
# yum install k3b
# yum install wine
```

In order to activate the 3D desktop effects, I needed to make a few changes in settings at *System -> Preferences -> Desktop environment*. I then began to enjoy the 3D effects.

KDE desktop

For all the KDE lovers, Figure 7 shows the default KDE boot screen, the default Goddard desktop background, and Home and Trash icons. My experience with KDE was not smooth. The moment I tried adding gadgets, the 'desktop folder' crashed. Well, this was the first time something crashed; nothing of this sort had happened in GNOME. Configuring the Internet was not as easy as with GNOME. In fact, when I closed Dolphin, that too crashed, and popped up a crash report. I guessed KDE was not yet stable, and that I should return to using GNOME for the rest of my review.

In a nutshell

Fedora 13 seems promising. Although I used the beta version, most of the things worked for me in the GNOME environment, with a little tweaking here and there. My KDE experience was not as good though. I'm looking forward to trying the GNOME version of the Fedora 13 final release after May 25. If things look better and more stable, then I could switch from Lucid Lynx to Goddard. But on second thoughts, maybe I will stick with Lucid! ;-) 

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